Saathi साथी

GOOGLE CLOUD BUILDATHON · SAATHI ON GOOGLE

A companion for India's elders, and paid care work for the women who already look after them.

Built on Gemini, Gemini Live, Gemma, Nano Banana, Cloud Run and Firebase. Live today, open source.

github.com/akshatinnovate-png/saathi-google

THE MOMENT

"Your account will be blocked. Please read me the number that just came on your phone."

Kamala, 79, lives alone in Pune and speaks Marathi. Her granddaughter Riya is in Toronto, her son in Bengaluru. Last winter a kind voice from "the bank" asked for her OTP.

She nearly read it out.

Millions of Indian families live this every day

- Tablets missed, or taken twice
- A fall that nobody hears
- Loneliness that goes unspoken
- "Digital arrest" and fake KYC calls
- Pension life certificates and letters she cannot read
- Family members who find out late

THE PROBLEM

Two problems, side by side

150M+

Indians over 60, set to double by 2050

Families are smaller and children move away, so more elders, most of them women, live alone. Today's tools are in English, app-heavy and built for the young. (UNFPA, India Ageing Report 2023)

Unpaid

The women who do the caring

Daughters, neighbours, ayahs and retired nurses carry most of India's care work and rarely earn from it. Families far away have no trusted way to find someone nearby for a doctor visit.

THE SOLUTION

One engine, three people

Aaji, the elder

A companion that speaks Marathi, Hindi or English. Tablets by colour, with no double doses. Check-ins, help that escalates until someone comes, scam warnings, messages translated both ways, fall checks on Android, and "what does this letter say?".

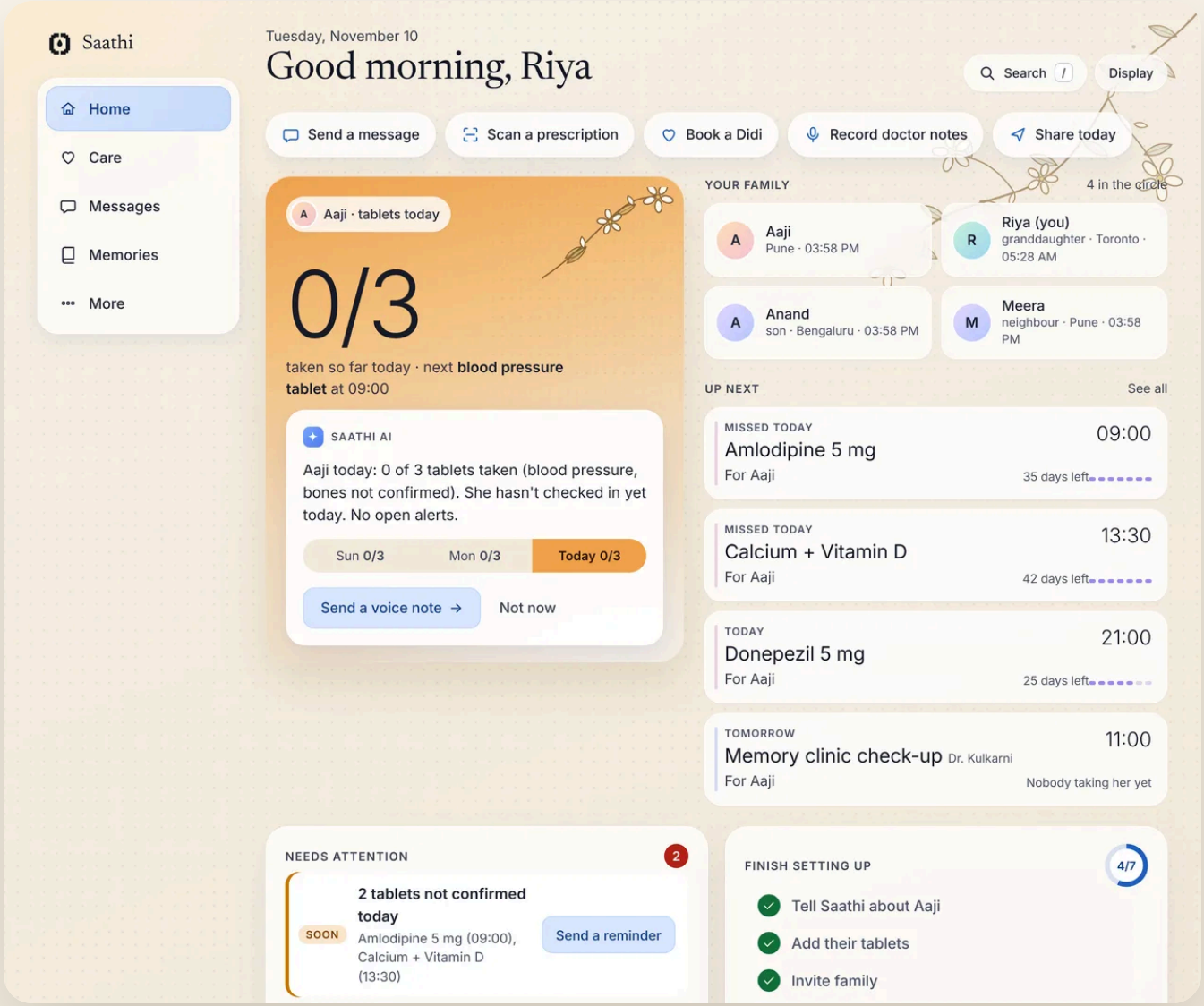
Riya, the family

One shared view in her own language. A needs-attention list where every item has one button. Prescriptions read from a photo. The doctor's advice summarised. One-tap protection with Undo.

Sunita, the Saathi Didi

Verified by her SHG or NGO and trained by voice. Bookings matched by real travel time, a Gemini briefing in her language, check-in, SOS and a visit note. Paid straight to her UPI, and she sets her own fee.

Nothing leaves the house without a yes. Safety features are always free. No ads.



The family app

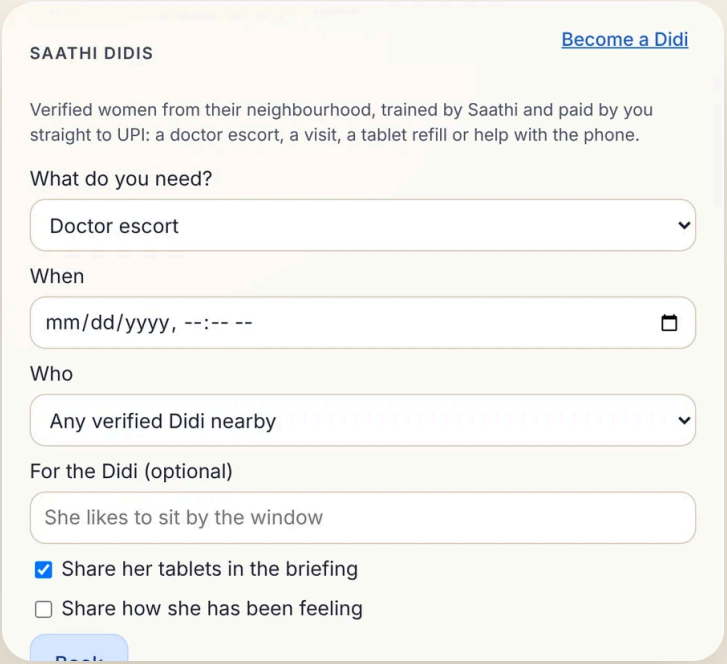
- **Needs attention**: help calls, missed tablets, low supply, nobody taking her to the doctor, benefit deadlines, each with one button
- **Finish setting up**: a checklist with a progress ring
- **Today**: tablets, routine and visits in one timeline
- Search everything with **/**; works in large text and high contrast



Her app, in Marathi. Requests near her, bookings and earnings.



A Gemini briefing with only what the family chose to share.



The family books her, reads her note in English and pays by UPI.

Plus SOS during every visit, families rated by Didis, overdue-visit checks, and **Saathi Sangat**: Didi-hosted Google Meet circles, a second income for her and company for Aaji.

GOOGLE AI

Gemini understands. Tested code decides.

Permissions, doses, escalations and payments run in tested code, with permission rules proven by Kani and TLA+.

Gemini API, on Vertex AI

Understands Aaji in Marathi and Hindi and calls Saathi's tools. Reads prescriptions ("1-0-1", BD, HS), tablet strips and official letters. Summarises doctor visits from audio. Writes Didi briefings in her language.

Gemini Live

Aaji just talks, and can interrupt. Saathi's tools work mid-conversation, and she is asked before anything is sent. The API key never reaches the browser.

Nano Banana

Makes each Didi's profile card (skills, languages, rating, verified badge) to share on WhatsApp and grow her work.

Gemma, on her phone

Scam Shield checks incoming texts and WhatsApp messages on the phone itself. She is warned in her language; the family hears only the kind of scam. The message never leaves her phone.

GOOGLE CLOUD

Deployed in one command

Run

Cloud Run in asia-south1: one warm instance for reminders and autoscaling for traffic. **Cloud Workflows** runs every help escalation step by step, surviving restarts.

Remember

Firestore with transactions for every household, booking and Didi. **Cloud Storage** for voice notes behind short-lived signed links. **Secret Manager** for keys.

Learn

Pub/Sub streams care events into **BigQuery**, which feeds the public impact page. **Cloud Logging** provides metrics and alerts.

Firebase Auth (phone sign-in) · Firebase Cloud Messaging · Maps Routes API · Cloud Translation · Speech-to-Text · Text-to-Speech (Marathi, Hindi, Tamil, Bengali) · Natural Language · Google Meet · Gmail API

TRUST

Built for the people most often targeted

Private by design

Every household's data is isolated. Private messages are end-to-end encrypted. Health records are sealed. Scam Shield reads her messages only on her phone. A Didi sees only what the family shares.

Safe sign-in

Passkeys, two-step codes and a 6-digit device pairing code with a family approval, so there are no passwords on Aaji's tablet.

Proven rules

Permission rules are written in Rust and checked with Kani proofs and TLA+ models in CI, alongside an automated attack suite and an HMAC-chained audit log.

Accessible

Every screen is checked with axe-core, in large text and high contrast, on phone and desktop. Speech is slower for hearing loss.

BUSINESS

Safety is free. Families pay for more.

WHO PAYS	FOR WHAT
Families	A low monthly Family plan: daily phone calls, Insight and the doctor report, and Family Voice reminders. Every safety feature stays free.
Families booking Didis	A small booking fee per visit or a monthly care plan. The Didi sets her own fee and keeps all of it, paid straight to her UPI.
Home-care organisations	Scheduling, briefing and verifying their caregivers through Saathi.
Later	Insurers, employers (elder-care benefits for staff with parents in other cities) and CSR programmes for SHG livelihoods.

TRACTION AND PLAN

Already real

- **200 elders** use Saathi
- **A home-care organisation** has accepted Saathi for its elders
- **Saathi on Google** is released: Android app, Windows installer and Docker image
- Open source, with 200+ automated tests, proofs and an accessibility audit in CI

Next 90 days

- Onboard the first Didis through our partner and local SHGs in Pune
- Pilot Didi bookings with Saathi families; measure visits, earnings and missed doses
- Add more Indian languages with Gemini and Cloud Text-to-Speech
- Grow through diaspora families in Canada, the US, the UK and the UAE

THE ASK

Help every Aaji stay safe at home, and every Sunita earn from the care she gives.

- Google Cloud credits
- Mentorship on Gemini Live and Vertex AI
- Introductions to home-care networks, SHG federations and employers

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